ORIONA ORGANIZATION

Annual Impact Report

March 2025 – March 2026 | Year One

Refugee-Led. Youth-Driven. Future-Focused.

Kakuma Refugee Camp & Urban Kenya
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1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

On 29th March 2026, ORIONA Organization marked its first full year of operations — a milestone that is both a celebration of impact achieved and a sobering reminder of how much more remains to be done for displaced youth across Kenya.

In Year One, ORIONA delivered measurable change across education, livelihoods, mental health and vocational training in both Kakuma Refugee Camp and urban Kenya. Operating primarily through volunteers and community-sourced support, the organization achieved a 100% success rate in its scholarship mentorship programs, placed over 100 youth into vocational training pathways, secured employment for refugee youth in Nairobi and provided psychosocial support to 64 young people.

This report documents ORIONA's first-year achievements, financial performance, operational challenges and strategic direction. It is presented with full transparency ,including an honest account of the financing gaps that represent our most critical barrier to scale.

2. YEAR ONE IMPACT AT A GLANCE

2
WUSC Scholarship Students

80
Grade 9 Students Guided

100
Vocational Trainees Placed

64
Youth Supported (PSS)

3
Jobs Secured (Nairobi)

1
University Placement

9
Hairdressing Trainees

8
Beading/Jewelry Trainees

3. PROGRAM-BY-PROGRAM ACHIEVEMENTS

3.1 Education & Scholarship Mentorship

ORIONA's education and mentorship pillar delivered its most celebrated results in Year One, achieving a 100% success rate across both scholarship programs it supported.

Student	Program	Status
Yar Deng	WUSC Scholarship Programme	Successfully Placed
Yar Adoor	WUSC Scholarship Programme	Successfully Placed

Both students were identified specifically due to financial constraints ,young people of clear potential who lacked the resources to pursue higher education without structured support. ORIONA provided mentorship, application guidance and accompaniment through the WUSC process, resulting in a clean 100% placement rate.

In parallel, ORIONA guided 80 Grade 9 students from Malakal and Shambe Primary Schools in Kakuma through the transition to senior high school, including application guidance for the Elimu Scholarship Programme. Again, the program achieved a 100% success rate ,a testament to the quality of coaching and the trust students placed in ORIONA's team.

Additionally, ORIONA secured one full student placement at Mount Kenya University, including full tuition and financial support — demonstrating ORIONA's capacity to broker meaningful higher education opportunities for refugee youth.

3.2 Vocational Training & Skills Development

One hundred Form 4 graduates were guided and supported into vocational training programs across three partner institutions:

Training Partner	Number of Trainees	Programs
Action for Refugee Life (AReL)	50 (10 ladies, 40 gents)	Various Digital Training and Advance Computer Applications programs
Peace For Development Refugee Initiative (PDRI)	10 gents	Basic Computer Applications
Don Bosco Vocational Training	40 gents	Various trades

This represents a significant pipeline achievement — 100 young people who may otherwise have had no structured pathway after completing Form 4 are now acquiring marketable, income-generating skills.

3.3 Skills Training — Hairdressing & Beading/Jewelry

ORIONA directly facilitated hands-on skills training for 17 young people:

- 9 young ladies trained in hairdressing — a trade with proven demand in both camp and urban settings

- 8 young men trained in beading and jewelry-making — enabling creative entrepreneurship and access to informal and formal markets

These programs represent ORIONA's direct delivery model: identifying youth, sourcing or facilitating training and connecting them to income opportunities.

3.4 Livelihoods & Employment

ORIONA facilitated and secured employment for 3 refugee youth in Nairobi — a significant milestone given the structural barriers refugee youth face in accessing formal urban employment:

- 2 youth secured construction sector employment
- 1 youth placed in a sales manager role

These placements demonstrate ORIONA's ability to bridge the gap between skills and real economic opportunity in urban Kenya — one of the most underserved segments in refugee support programming.

3.5 Mental Health & Psychosocial Support (PSS)

64 young refugees received mental health and psychosocial support through ORIONA's peer counseling and safe space model. In a context where mental health services are chronically under-resourced and where many displaced youth carry significant trauma, this program represents one of ORIONA's most impactful contributions.

ORIONA's philosophy is clear: sustainable empowerment cannot be built without first addressing mental wellbeing. As the organization has stated: a person cannot build a future with a broken mind.

4. FINANCIAL OVERVIEW & ALLOCATION

ORIONA operated Year One primarily on community-sourced funding, small partnerships and volunteer contributions. The following reflects the approximate allocation of funds received during the year:

Budget Category	Allocation (%)	Notes
Legal Fees & Compliance	20%	Registration, legal structure, formal compliance
Program Delivery	30%	Direct training, scholarships, mentorship support
Volunteer Stipends	~25%	Support for community volunteers driving delivery
Transport & Facilitation	~15%	Movement of staff, materials, beneficiary logistics
Operational & Other Costs	~10%	Communications, administration, coordination

A significant observation is that 20% of all funds in Year One were consumed by legal fees — costs associated with the formal establishment, registration and compliance requirements for a new organization. This is a common but underappreciated burden for emerging community-based organizations. As ORIONA's legal foundations are now established, this cost category is expected to reduce substantially in Year Two, freeing resources for direct program delivery.

Only 30% of available funds went directly to programs. While understandable given the infrastructural investments required in Year One, this ratio must improve. ORIONA's goal in Year Two is to increase program allocation to at least 55–60% of total funds, contingent on securing adequate unrestricted or multi-year funding.

5. CHALLENGES & CRITICAL GAPS

5.1 Financing: The Primary Barrier

The single most significant challenge ORIONA faces and the one most directly limiting its impact — is the absence of sustainable, adequate funding for programs and operations.

Year One demonstrated what ORIONA can achieve with very limited resources: 100 vocational trainees placed, 84 students successfully guided through scholarship applications, 64 young people supported with mental health services and employment secured for refugees in Nairobi. These outcomes were delivered largely on volunteer energy and community goodwill. But they represent only a fraction of ORIONA's potential.

The consequences of underfunding are real and visible:

- Training programs cannot be sustained or scaled without consistent funding for materials, facilitator fees and institutional partnerships
- Volunteer-based delivery creates staff burnout and limits program quality and consistency
- Urban refugee programming in Nairobi and other cities requires dedicated resourcing that ORIONA currently lacks
- Monitoring, evaluation and impact reporting — critical for donor accountability — cannot be properly implemented without investment in systems and personnel
- Competitive disadvantage relative to internationally-funded NGOs limits ORIONA's visibility despite superior community relevance

5.2 Legal & Compliance Costs

As noted in the financial overview, 20% of Year One funds were absorbed by legal and registration costs — a disproportionate burden for a first-year community organization. While these foundations are now in place and this cost should not recur at the same level, it significantly constrained program delivery in Year One.

5.3 Operational Infrastructure

ORIONA currently lacks formalized systems for monitoring and evaluation, and human resources. Building these systems is necessary not only for internal effectiveness, but as a precondition for most institutional donors. This creates a catch-22: systems require funding, but funding increasingly requires systems.

5.4 Urban Refugee Visibility

Urban refugees in Nairobi, Nakuru, Eldoret, Kitale and other Kenyan cities represent an enormous and underserved population. They have legal freedom of movement but often lack the networks, support structures and access to opportunity that would make that freedom meaningful. ORIONA is positioned to serve this population, but lacks the resources to do so at scale.

6. STRATEGIC PRIORITIES FOR YEAR TWO (2026–2027)

Building on Year One's foundation, ORIONA has identified five strategic priorities for the coming year:

Priority	Target Outcome
1. Secure Anchor Funding	Identify 2–3 institutional or foundation partners to fund core programs at a minimum of 12-month grants
2. Expand Urban Programming	Launch structured programming in Nairobi targeting 50+ urban refugee youth in skills and employment
3. Build M&E Systems	Implement a basic monitoring and evaluation framework to track and report program impact rigorously
4. Increase Program Allocation	Grow program spend from 30% to 55%+ of total budget through cost discipline and new funding
5. Employer & Institution Partnerships	Sign 5+ formal employer or training partnerships to expand job placement and vocational certification

7. CALL TO PARTNERSHIP

ORIONA's first year proves that the model works. Young people who were written off by circumstance are now in universities, in jobs, in training centers and in peer counseling clubs. They are building futures. They are giving back.

What ORIONA needs now is resources proportional to the need. We are actively seeking:

- Funding partners — foundations, bilateral donors and corporates with CSR mandates aligned to refugee inclusion and youth empowerment
- Employer partners — businesses in Nairobi and across Kenya willing to offer placements, apprenticeships and entry-level employment to ORIONA graduates
- NGO and UN agency partners — for referral networks, co-programming and resource sharing
- Academic institutions — for curriculum development, credentialing and research partnerships
- Media and advocacy partners — to amplify refugee voices and document ORIONA's growing impact

ORIONA does not ask for charity. It asks for the investment that transforms potential into contribution — and displacement into direction.

Madul Gieth Mijak

Founder & Executive Director, ORIONA Organization

Kakuma Refugee Camp, Turkana County, Kenya | April 2026